



Penguins' feet are positioned so far back that when they stand upright, they have to use their tails to balance or they would topple over backwards.

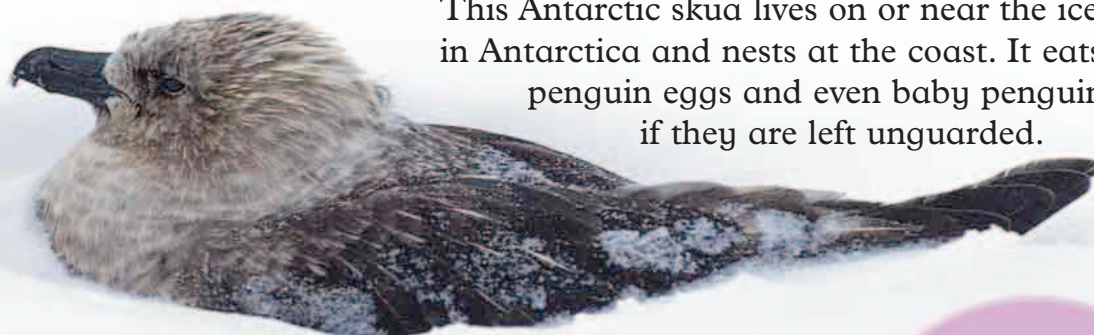
Adult penguins have white tummies and dark backs, which help to camouflage them in the water.

Other snow birds

One of the few birds that lives and breeds on Antarctica all year round is the snow petrel. It is completely white, which keeps it hidden in the snow.



Antarctic skua



Penguin predators

This Antarctic skua lives on or near the ice in Antarctica and nests at the coast. It eats penguin eggs and even baby penguins if they are left unguarded.

Penguin parents

King penguins tuck their eggs under their bellies, resting them on their feet. The parents take turns to look after their egg. When king penguin chicks are born, they are covered in brown, downy feathers.



In very cold conditions chicks and penguins huddle together for warmth.

Turn and learn

Flightless birds:

pp. 78-79

Other sea birds:

pp. 64-65

Slip-sliding around

Penguins find it hard to walk, so they often slide on their bellies over snow and ice, pushing with their flippers and feet.

The chicks must be fed until they grow adult, waterproof feathers

